# Professional Dispositions Self-Assessment

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## Dispositional Strengths

My strongest dispositional areas are Ethics, Professional Identity and Continuous Growth, and Collaboration.

Ethics is where I am most confident. My work has always involved protected student records and federal benefits data, where confidentiality is not optional and errors have real consequences for a student. That built the habit of following policy carefully and owning mistakes plainly rather than hoping they go unnoticed.

Professional Identity and Continuous Growth follows from how I have moved through several very different roles, each requiring me to learn a new domain quickly. I finished a graduate degree while working full time and am now starting a second one in a field that is new to me. Working in a technical environment where my work is reviewed regularly has also made me comfortable treating feedback as information rather than criticism.

Collaboration is a strength because of the position I usually occupy, which is between technical staff and the people who use what we build. The two groups rarely describe a problem the same way, so much of my job is listening long enough to hear what someone actually needs underneath the solution they are asking for.

I would add Advocacy as an emerging strength. Helping student veterans navigate benefits made it hard for me to think about learners in the abstract. People get stuck on unclear requirements and give up on programs they could have finished. I now evaluate any design by asking who it is going to fail and why.

## Areas for Improvement

My areas for improvement are Impact and Leadership.

Impact is the area where I have the least direct evidence. The indicators are written around learners and assessment results, and my career has been on the systems and support side rather than in front of a classroom. I believe the underlying commitment is there, but I have not yet had to design instruction, look at how learners actually performed, and adjust

based on what the data showed. My strategy is to treat every design assignment in this program as practice in that loop, which means building in a way to check whether the design worked instead of assuming it did, and seeking out a project or practicum where I am responsible for real learners rather than hypothetical ones.

Leadership needs work for a different reason. I am comfortable initiating and contributing on the technical side, but disseminating current research and best practices is new territory. I am at the beginning of the literature in this field and have more reading to do than telling. My strategy is to build the habit early by staying current with the field's journals and professional organizations, participating actively in course discussions rather than only completing them, and looking for chances to present or write up what I learn once I have something worth sharing.

A related habit I want to manage is my tendency to keep refining a solution past the point of usefulness. It comes from a good instinct, but it can delay work that others are waiting on. I plan to address it by setting deadlines for my own drafts and getting feedback earlier, while the work is still rough enough to change.